A Brief About Bādghīs

Of the thirty-four provinces in Afghanistan, Bādghīs lies in the north-western part, sharing the border with Herat, Ghor and Faryab provinces and Turkmenistan. Currently, it is one of the most underdeveloped parts of the country with the highest rate of poverty.[*] Qala-i-Naw is the capital of the land and Bala Murghab is known to be the land of the highest population. This populous city also happens to be the place near to ruins of the medieval city of Marw al-Rudh, the historical capital of the medieval region of Gharjistan.

The total area of the province is 20,591 square kilometres and the Murghab River forms the base for irrigation. It has a few mountains, but characteristically it is dominated by the rolling hills divided by ravines. The current name of the province comes from its very trait of being very windy. The name 'Badhgis' is the corruption of the Persian compound '*bâd-khiz*' which means 'wind source'. It perhaps refers to the steppe winds that blow into the province from the north and north-western edge. The northern border kisses the edge of the Karakum desert and is known as the Sarakhs desert.

Till the marauding invaders from Arab land didn't plunder this land, it was the centre of the Kingdom of Badghis. The king of Badghis Trakhan Tirek had very bravely resisted the Umayyad Invasion of AD 709. Post the Arab conquest for almost two-and-a-half centuries of years, this land became a place of religious dissent by the locals. It was the summer pastures for the Tīmūrids in the fifteenth century (the era that this book addresses) for its great characteristic of being grasslands. But down the four centuries, the place was completely devastated by the Turkmen raids.[†]

Babur's Narrative Continues

Now, Babur had laid custom duty on the Turks and other clans of the region. By doing so, he had earned not less than 300 tūmāns of kipkī. Just a few days before Babur had arrived at the valley of Bām, Aūzbeg raiders had received a heavy beating from Ẕū'n-nūn Beg's men and the light troops of Khurāsān at places namely, Pand-dih and Marūchāq. A huge mass of Aūzbegs were killed in this scuffle. Sons of Sulṭān Husayn, Badī'u'z-zamān Mīrzā and Muẓaffar-i-ḥusayn Mīrzā were still up with the motive to dismantle Shaybāni Khān. They collaborated with Muhammad Barandūq Barlās, Ẕū'n-nūn Arghūn and his son Shāh Beg, determined to overrun Shaybāni Khān and then besiege Sulṭān Qul-i-